Bylaws – Building 4 Our Future

Draft prepared Oct 22, 2026

Article I. Name and Offices

1.1 Name. The name of the corporation is Building 4 Our Future ("B4OF" or the "Corporation"), an Illinois not-for-profit corporation.

1.2 Offices. The principal office is in Chicago, Illinois, at the address the Board designates. The registered office and agent are as stated in the Articles of Incorporation, and the Board may change them as Illinois law allows.

1.3 Tax-exempt status. The Corporation intends to operate as an organization described in Section 501(c)(3) of the Internal Revenue Code (the "Code"). Until the IRS recognizes that status, the Corporation will not describe itself as tax-exempt and will not promise donors that their gifts are tax-deductible.

Article II. Purposes

2.1 Purposes. The Corporation is organized and operated exclusively for the charitable and educational purposes stated in its Articles of Incorporation, as amended. Its work is to teach financial literacy and economic skills to youth, adults, and aspiring entrepreneurs in underserved communities, and to provide youth mentoring, development, and athletic programs.

2.2 Limits. No part of the net earnings of the Corporation benefits any director, officer, or private person, except for reasonable compensation for services and payments that further the Corporation's purposes. The Corporation does not take part in political campaigns, and lobbying is limited to what Section 501(c)(3) permits.

Article III. No Members

3.1 No voting members. The Corporation has no members within the meaning of the Illinois General Not For Profit Corporation Act. The Board of Directors holds all rights and powers that the Act gives to members.

3.2 Supporters. The Board may recognize supporters, alumni, volunteers, or participants and may offer them titles such as "Friend of B4OF." These persons have no voting rights and no rights in the Corporation's property.

Article IV. Board of Directors

4.1 Powers. The Board manages the Corporation's affairs. It sets policy, approves the annual budget, oversees finances and programs, and hires and supervises any Executive Director. The Board may delegate day-to-day management to officers or staff but remains responsible for the Corporation.

4.2 Number. The Board has at least three (3) and no more than nine (9) directors. The Board sets the exact number by resolution. The initial directors are those named in the Articles of Incorporation. Because some initial directors have interests in Related Organizations, the Board will seat enough additional independent directors, as soon as practical and before approving any arrangement with a Related Organization, to meet Section 4.3. The Board's goal is at least five (5) directors within the first year.

4.3 Independence. At all times, a majority of directors must be independent. An "independent director" is a person who (a) is not compensated by the Corporation as an employee or independent contractor, (b) is not related by blood, marriage, or domestic partnership to any compensated person or to another director, and (c) does not own, manage, or work for, and is not a family member of an owner or manager of, any Related Organization. A "Related Organization" is any business or organization that a director, officer, or founder (or a family member of one) owns or manages, including Block Wall Street LLC and Sun School of Satoshi LLC. No more than two directors at one time may have an interest in a Related Organization, and no more than one director may be a member of the same family.

4.4 Qualifications. Directors must be at least 18 years old, support the Corporation's mission, and be willing to sign the Conflict of Interest Policy before taking office and each year after. Professional experience, lived experience in the communities served, or both are valued.

4.5 Terms. Directors serve staggered three-year terms. The Board assigns initial terms of one, two, or three years so that about one-third of the seats come up each year. Directors may be re-elected without limit. Each director serves until a successor is elected or the director resigns or is removed.

4.6 Election. Directors are elected by a majority vote of the directors in office at the annual meeting or at any meeting called for that purpose. A candidate may be nominated by any director.

4.7 Vacancies. The Board may fill a vacancy, including a newly created seat, by majority vote of the directors in office. A director elected to fill a vacancy serves the rest of the vacant term.

4.8 Resignation. A director may resign at any time by written notice to the Board Chair or Secretary.

4.9 Removal. The Board may remove a director with or without cause by a two-thirds (2/3) vote of the directors in office, after written notice to the director and a chance to respond. A director who misses three consecutive regular meetings without excuse may be treated as having resigned if the Board so votes.

4.10 Board Chair. The Board elects one of its independent directors as Chair for a one-year term. The Chair presides at Board meetings, sets the agenda with the President, and leads the annual review of the Executive Director or President. If no Chair is elected, the President presides.

4.11 Duties. Directors owe the Corporation duties of care, loyalty, and obedience to its mission. They attend meetings, review financial reports, act in good faith, and put the Corporation's interests ahead of their own. Directors serve without pay for their service as directors. They may be reimbursed for reasonable, documented expenses approved by the Board.

Article V. Meetings

5.1 Annual meeting. The Board holds an annual meeting each year to elect directors and officers, review the finances and programs, and adopt the budget. The Board sets its date and place.

5.2 Regular meetings. The Board meets at least four (4) times a year, at least once each quarter, on dates it sets in advance.

5.3 Special meetings. The Chair, the President, or any two directors may call a special meeting.

5.4 Notice. The Secretary gives each director written notice (mail or email) of the date, time, place or video link, and agenda: at least five (5) days before a regular or annual meeting, and at least two (2) days before a special meeting. A director waives notice by

attending without objection or by signing a written waiver. A special meeting is limited to the purposes in its notice unless every director is present and agrees.

5.5 Remote participation. Directors may attend by video or phone if all participants can hear each other at the same time. A director attending this way counts as present.

5.6 Action without a meeting. The Board may act without a meeting if every director signs a written consent (including by email or electronic signature) stating the action taken. The Secretary files the consent with the minutes.

5.7 Order of business. A standard agenda covers: call to order, roll call, approval of minutes, officer and committee reports, financial report, program update, old business, new business, and adjournment. Robert's Rules of Order guide a meeting where these Bylaws are silent.

5.8 Minutes. The Secretary, or a person the Chair names, records minutes of every Board and committee meeting. The minutes list who attended, what was decided, and how each director voted on important matters. Draft minutes go to directors within 14 days, and approved minutes are signed by the Chair and Secretary.

Article VI. Quorum and Voting

6.1 Quorum. A majority of the directors in office is a quorum. If only three directors are in office, two make a quorum. The Board takes no action without a quorum.

6.2 Voting. Each director has one vote. Unless these Bylaws or Illinois law require more, the Board acts by a majority vote of the directors present at a meeting with a quorum. A director cannot vote by proxy.

6.3 Supermajority votes. These actions require a two-thirds (2/3) vote of the directors in office: removing a director, amending the Articles of Incorporation, approving a sale of substantially all assets, merging, or dissolving.

6.4 Interested directors. A director with a conflict of interest on a matter does not vote on it and is not counted toward the vote needed for it, as the Conflict of Interest Policy provides. The director may be counted toward a quorum for other matters. For any matter under Section 10.2 (Related Organizations), only independent directors with no interest in the matter may vote, a quorum is a majority of those independent directors in office, and at least two of them must vote in favor.

Article VII. Officers and Staff

7.1 Officers. The officers are a President, a Secretary, and a Treasurer. The Board may also elect a Vice President and other officers. Officers must be directors unless the Board decides otherwise. The same person may hold more than one office, except that no one may serve as both President and Treasurer, and no one may serve as both President and Secretary.

7.2 Election and term. The Board elects officers at the annual meeting for one-year terms. Officers may be re-elected. The Board may remove any officer at any time by majority vote of the directors in office, and may fill any officer vacancy.

7.3 President. The President is the Corporation's chief executive officer. The President carries out the Board's decisions, directs programs and operations, represents the Corporation publicly, signs contracts the Board has approved, and reports to the Board at each regular meeting. The President may not enter into a contract above the limit set by Board resolution without Board approval.

7.4 Vice President. If the Board elects a Vice President, that officer acts for the President when the President is absent or unable to act, and performs other duties the Board assigns.

7.5 Secretary. The Secretary gives notice of meetings, keeps the minutes and corporate records, keeps a current copy of the Articles, Bylaws, and policies, and keeps the signed conflict of interest statements.

7.6 Treasurer. The Treasurer oversees the Corporation's funds and accounts, makes sure funds go into Board-approved accounts, reports on finances at each regular meeting, presents the annual budget, and sees that tax returns and state filings are prepared and filed on time. The Treasurer may delegate bookkeeping to a qualified person but remains responsible for oversight.

7.7 Executive Director and staff. The Board may hire an Executive Director and other staff when funds allow. The Board sets their duties and pay following Article IX. The Executive Director reports to the Board, hires and supervises other staff, and may not vote as a director unless also elected as one. Staff may be given titles such as Program Director or Director of Operations without being officers.

7.8 Bank accounts and checks. All funds go into accounts in the Corporation's own name and tax ID. Any payment above a limit the Board sets requires two authorized signers or two approvals, and a person may not approve a payment to themselves or to a family member.

Article VIII. Committees

8.1 Creating committees. The Board may create committees by majority vote and set their duties. A committee that exercises Board authority must have at least two directors and be chaired by a director. Other committees are advisory and may include non-directors.

8.2 Limits. No committee may amend the Articles or Bylaws, elect or remove directors or officers, approve a merger or dissolution, approve its own members' pay, or adopt a budget.

8.3 Suggested committees. As the Corporation grows, the Board is encouraged to form a Finance Committee, a Program and Curriculum Committee, a Resource Development Committee, and a Governance Committee. Until then, the full Board performs these functions.

8.4 Reports. Each committee keeps minutes and reports to the Board at each regular meeting.

Article IX. Compensation

9.1 Reasonable pay only. The Corporation may pay reasonable compensation to officers, employees, and contractors for services that further its purposes. It never pays more than the value of the services.

9.2 Who approves. The Board, acting only through directors who have no conflict of interest in the matter, approves the pay of any officer, director, founder, family member of any of them, or Executive Director. Before approving, the Board reviews comparable pay at similar organizations, records the data it relied on, and records its decision in the minutes at the time it is made.

9.3 Directors. Directors are not paid for serving as directors. A director who is also paid as staff or a contractor does not take part in decisions about that pay.

9.4 Annual review. The Board reviews all compensation of officers and any Executive Director at least once a year.

Article X. Conflicts of Interest and Related Parties

10.1 Policy. The Board adopts and follows a written Conflict of Interest Policy. Every director, officer, and key staff member signs it when starting and updates the disclosure each year.

10.2 Related organizations. The Corporation may work with, license from, buy from, or share costs with any business, including one owned or controlled by a director, officer, founder, or their relatives. Every such arrangement must be (a) in writing, (b) on terms at least as favorable to the Corporation as fair market value, (c) disclosed to the Board in advance, (d) approved by the independent directors who have no interest in the arrangement, after they compare alternatives, and (e) recorded in the minutes, with each interested director absent from the discussion and vote. The Corporation does not subsidize any for-profit business. It keeps its own bank accounts, books, name, and records, separate from every related organization.

10.3 Intellectual property. Any curriculum, content, or brand the Corporation uses from another person or business is used under a written license. Any curriculum the Corporation creates with its own funds belongs to the Corporation unless the Board approves a different written arrangement.

10.4 Loans. The Corporation does not lend money to directors or officers.

10.5 Founder. The Board may recognize the founder of the Corporation with the title "Founder," or by electing the founder a director or officer. A founder has no ownership of the Corporation or its assets and no right to control it. A founder's influence comes only from service on the Board or in a role the Board assigns, and any pay is set under Article IX.

10.6 Schedule of interests. The Secretary keeps a current list of every director's, officer's, and founder's interests in Related Organizations (Schedule A to the Conflict of Interest Policy). The list is updated at least once a year and whenever ownership or management of a Related Organization changes.

Article XI. Finances

11.1 Fiscal year. The fiscal year runs January 1 through December 31.

11.2 Budget. The Board adopts an annual budget before each fiscal year starts. Spending above the budget, or over any limit the Board sets, needs Board approval.

11.3 Restricted gifts. Gifts given for a stated purpose are used only for that purpose and tracked separately.

11.4 Gift acknowledgments. The Corporation gives donors written acknowledgments that meet IRS rules. It describes gifts as tax-deductible only after the IRS has recognized its exemption.

11.5 Filings and registrations. The Treasurer makes sure the Corporation files its annual report with the Illinois Secretary of State, the annual IRS information return (Form 990-series) when due, and any charitable registration or state tax filings that apply. The Board reviews these filings before they are submitted.

11.6 Outside review. The Board arranges an independent financial review or audit when Illinois law or a funder requires one, and may do so at any other time.

11.7 Investments. The Board approves an investment policy before the Corporation invests funds. Any investment in crypto-assets or other volatile assets is allowed only as the Board's written policy permits, including rules for custody, approval, and reporting.

Article XII. Records

12.1 What is kept. The Secretary keeps the Articles and amendments, Bylaws, IRS determination letter and tax filings, minutes, signed conflict of interest statements, contracts, and policies. The Treasurer keeps financial records and receipts.

12.2 How long. The Corporation keeps governing documents, minutes, and tax-exemption records permanently, and financial and other records for at least seven (7) years.

12.3 Access. Any director may inspect the Corporation's records for a proper purpose.

Article XIII. Indemnification

To the fullest extent Illinois law allows, the Corporation will protect directors, officers, and volunteers against claims arising from good-faith service to the Corporation, and may buy insurance for that purpose. This protection does not cover willful misconduct, bad faith, or personal financial benefit the person was not entitled to receive.

Article XIV. Amendments and Dissolution

14.1 Amending the Bylaws. The Board may amend these Bylaws by a majority vote of the directors in office, at a meeting where the notice, sent at least seven (7) days ahead, includes the proposed text. No amendment may conflict with the Articles of Incorporation, the Corporation's charitable purposes, or Section 501(c)(3) of the Code.

14.2 Dissolution. On dissolution, the Corporation's assets are distributed only as the Articles of Incorporation provide: to one or more organizations exempt under Section 501(c)(3), or to a government for a public purpose. No director, officer, or private person receives any of those assets.

Certificate of Adoption

We, the undersigned, are the directors of Building 4 Our Future, an Illinois not-for-profit corporation. By written consent, we adopt these Bylaws as the Bylaws of the Corporation, effective on the date below.

Director (print name)	Signature	Date
Isun Jones-Boler		
Tawanda Jennings		
Samuel Harris		
(Additional director, if seated)		

Secretary's Certificate

I certify that I am the Secretary of Building 4 Our Future and that these are the Bylaws adopted by the Board of Directors on _____, 2026.

Secretary signature: _____ Date: _____

Directors named above are those listed in the filed Articles of Incorporation. If any of them have changed or declined to serve, replace the names before signing, and have the Board record the change in the minutes. The Board must seat at least two more independent directors (Section 4.3) before it approves any arrangement with a Related Organization.